

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Globalisation, Trade Agreements and External-Policy Effects - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Globalisation, Trade Agreements and External-Policy Effects	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 FOUNDATION — WHAT THIS EXTERNAL-EFFECTS OWNER HOLDS AND HOW Technically, FOUNDATION — What this external-effects owner holds	02 FOUNDATION — WANING RATHER THAN ENDED AS THE GOVERNING FRAME Prelims: Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated
03 FOUNDATION — THREE CHANNELS AND WHY THE CHANNEL MUST BE NAMED Evidence chain: The three transmission channels that carry the shift to	04 CORE — WHAT THE TRADE ORGANISATION IS AND HOW IT DECIDES The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03
05 CORE — THE MINISTERIAL CYCLE AND THE LIMIT OF NEAR-UNANIMITY Evidence chain: The ministerial cycle and what the fourteenth	06 CORE — A PARALYSED APPELLATE STAGE INSIDE INDIA'S OWN DOCKET Evidence chain: Appeals into the void and the two-sided cost of a
07 CORE — ADOPTION, ENTRY INTO FORCE AND INDIVIDUAL ACCEPTANCE IN ONE CHAIN The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03	08 CORE — AGRICULTURE, STOCKHOLDING AND A DISTRIBUTIVE REFORM DEMAND Evidence chain: Agriculture, public stockholding and the reform
09 CORE — THE LADDER FROM CONCLUDED TO IN FORCE The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact	10 CORE — TWO AGREEMENTS IN FORCE AND WHAT EACH ACTUALLY CARRIES The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade
11 CORE — CONCLUDED NEGOTIATIONS AND THE BOUNDARY INDIA DREW The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it	12 CORE — THE CARBON-BORDER REGIME AS A LIVE THIRD CHANNEL The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records
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Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this external-effects owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. B. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. D. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q2. Which card should be filed under What this external-effects owner holds and how its boundaries are routed in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. B. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. C. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this external-effects owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. B. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. C. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. D. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this external-effects owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. B. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. C. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. D. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Co-presence rather than succession as the governing frame?

A. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. B. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. C. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q6. Which card should be filed under Co-presence rather than succession as the governing frame in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. B. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. C. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Co-presence rather than succession as the governing frame?

A. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. B. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. C. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. D. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Co-presence rather than succession as the governing frame?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. B. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. C. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. D. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The three transmission channels that carry the shift to India?

A. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. B. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. C. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q10. Which card should be filed under The three transmission channels that carry the shift to India in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues

breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. B. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. C. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. D. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The three transmission channels that carry the shift to India?

A. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. B. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that

negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. C. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. D. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The three transmission channels that carry the shift to India?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. B. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. C. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and

that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. D. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies What the trade organisation is and how it actually decides?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. B. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. C. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. D. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment

Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March.

Answer: A. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q14. Which card should be filed under What the trade organisation is and how it actually decides in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. B. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. D. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.

Answer: B. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a

whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What the trade organisation is and how it actually decides?

A. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. B. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. D. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.

Answer: C. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member

countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What the trade organisation is and how it actually decides?

A. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. B. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

Answer: D. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost

body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The ministerial cycle and what the fourteenth conference actually did?

A. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. B. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. D. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout,

minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q18. Which card should be filed under The ministerial cycle and what the fourteenth conference actually did in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. B. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. C. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout,

minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The ministerial cycle and what the fourteenth conference actually did?

A. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium

questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The ministerial cycle and what the fourteenth conference actually did?

A. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. D. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout,

minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Consensus as the veto point that near-unanimity cannot overcome?

A. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. B. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. C. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. D. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q22. Which card should be filed under Consensus as the veto point that near-unanimity cannot overcome in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. B. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. C. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Consensus as the veto point that near-unanimity cannot overcome?

A. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. D. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Consensus as the veto point that near-unanimity cannot overcome?

A. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. B. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up

to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. C. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. D. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Appeals into the void and the two-sided cost of a paralysed appellate stage?

A. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation

with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. D. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q26. Which card should be filed under Appeals into the void and the two-sided cost of a paralysed appellate stage in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. B. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. C. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in

force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. D. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Appeals into the void and the two-sided cost of a paralysed appellate stage?

A. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff

treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. D. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Appeals into the void and the two-sided cost of a paralysed appellate stage?

A. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. B. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. C. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. D. The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The fisheries agreement as the clean adoption-to-acceptance sequence?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. D. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural.

Answer: A. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean

sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q30. Which card should be filed under The fisheries agreement as the clean adoption-to-acceptance sequence in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. B. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. C. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. D. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access.

Answer: B. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15

September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The fisheries agreement as the clean adoption-to-acceptance sequence?

A. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. B. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. D. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Answer: C. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The fisheries agreement as the clean adoption-to-acceptance sequence?

A. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. B. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. C. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance.

Answer: D. Explanation: The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Agriculture, public stockholding and the reform demand India actually makes?

A. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. D. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q34. Which card should be filed under Agriculture, public stockholding and the reform demand India actually makes in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. B. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali

peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. C. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. D. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agriculture, public stockholding and the reform demand India actually makes?

A. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. B. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. C. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. D. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the

cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agriculture, public stockholding and the reform demand India actually makes?

A. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. B. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. C. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. D. The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The status vocabulary that decides whether a trade claim is true?

A. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. B. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. C. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. D. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q38. Which card should be filed under The status vocabulary that decides whether a trade claim is true in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. B. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. C. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. D. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The status vocabulary that decides whether a trade claim is true?

A. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. B. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. C. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. D. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The status vocabulary that decides whether a trade claim is true?

A. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. B. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. C. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. D. The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The European trade partnership in force and the objective that is not an outcome?

A. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. B. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. C. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. D. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q42. Which card should be filed under The European trade partnership in force and the objective that is not an outcome in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. B. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. C. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading

System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. D. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The European trade partnership in force and the objective that is not an outcome?

A. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. B. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. C. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. D. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment

or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The European trade partnership in force and the objective that is not an outcome?

A. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. B. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. C. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. D. The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The United Kingdom agreement in force and its social-security companion?

A. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. B. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. C. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. D. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q46. Which card should be filed under The United Kingdom agreement in force and its social-security companion in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. B. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. C. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the

regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. D. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The United Kingdom agreement in force and its social-security companion?

A. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. B. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. C. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. D. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they

attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The United Kingdom agreement in force and its social-security companion?

A. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. B. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. C. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. D. The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Concluded negotiations and the same-summit verb discipline?

A. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. B. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. C. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. D. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q50. Which card should be filed under Concluded negotiations and the same-summit verb discipline in an International Relations answer?

A. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. B. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither

signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. C. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. D. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Concluded negotiations and the same-summit verb discipline?

A. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. B. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. C. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. D. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a

twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Concluded negotiations and the same-summit verb discipline?

A. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. B. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. C. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. D. The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the

verb the source actually used. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The withdrawal decision that defines India's own trade boundary?

A. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. B. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. C. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. D. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q54. Which card should be filed under The withdrawal decision that defines India's own trade boundary in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. B. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral

agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. C. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. D. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The withdrawal decision that defines India's own trade boundary?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. B. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. C. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. D. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market

access, tariff exposure or bargaining power.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The withdrawal decision that defines India's own trade boundary?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. B. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. C. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. D. The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The carbon-border mechanism as the third channel in operation?

A. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. B. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. C. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. D. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power.

Answer: A. Explanation: The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q58. Which card should be filed under The carbon-border mechanism as the third channel in operation in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade

friction from partners. B. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. C. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. D. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes.

Answer: B. Explanation: The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The carbon-border mechanism as the third channel in operation?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. B. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market

access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. C. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. D. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners.

Answer: C. Explanation: The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The carbon-border mechanism as the third channel in operation?

A. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. B. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to

describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. D. The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law.

Answer: D. Explanation: The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Unilateral tariff action and why volatility rather than level is the mechanism?

A. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. B. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. C. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. D. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure

of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q62. Which card should be filed under Unilateral tariff action and why volatility rather than level is the mechanism in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. B. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. C. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is

the transmission mechanism an answer should name. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Unilateral tariff action and why volatility rather than level is the mechanism?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. B. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. C. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Unilateral tariff action and why volatility rather than level is the mechanism?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. B. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. C. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. D. The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Climate diplomacy as an external-policy arena in its own right?

A. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. B. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. D. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q66. Which card should be filed under Climate diplomacy as an external-policy arena in its own right in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. B. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. C. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Climate diplomacy as an external-policy arena in its own right?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. B. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. C. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. D. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Climate diplomacy as an external-policy arena in its own right?

A. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. B. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. C. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. D. The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to achieve about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target, that India's negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access alongside domestic mitigation, and that the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; the owners state plainly that targets are commitments and not proof of realised outcomes. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The structural indicator behind the export-diversification push?

A. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. B. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into

Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. D. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q70. Which card should be filed under The structural indicator behind the export-diversification push in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. B. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. C. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others'

measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The structural indicator behind the export-diversification push?

A. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. B. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. C. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. D. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The structural indicator behind the export-diversification push?

A. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. B. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. D. The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Agreement proliferation as continuity of liberalisation and its fragmentation cost?

A. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. B. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. C. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q74. Which card should be filed under Agreement proliferation as continuity of liberalisation and its fragmentation cost in an International Relations answer?

A. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. B. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. C. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. D. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agreement proliferation as continuity of liberalisation and its fragmentation cost?

A. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. B. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to

a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. C. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. D. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agreement proliferation as continuity of liberalisation and its fragmentation cost?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. B. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. C. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own

conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. D. The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Honest question ownership for this external-effects owner?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. B. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. C. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. D. This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from

2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q78. Which card should be filed under Honest question ownership for this external-effects owner in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. B. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. C. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. D. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Honest question ownership for this external-effects owner?

A. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. B. The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. D. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Honest question ownership for this external-effects owner?

A. The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. B. The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. C. The owners record that the thirteenth Ministerial Conference met at Abu Dhabi from 26 February to 2 March 2024 and produced the Abu Dhabi Ministerial Declaration with decisions on dispute-settlement reform, special and differential treatment, least-developed-country graduation and electronic commerce, and that the fourteenth met at Yaounde in Cameroon from 26 to 30 March 2026, taking decisions on small economies and on sanitary, phytosanitary and technical-barrier implementation and continuing fisheries negotiations toward the fifteenth conference while electronic-commerce moratorium questions remained unresolved; the organisation's own conference page checked live on 2026-09-03 confirms the calendar and agenda, recording an opening on 26 March with a foundational-issues breakout, minister-facilitated reform breakouts and a reform plenary on 27 March, a third day opening with a dispute-settlement reform update and continuing through ministerial sessions on fisheries subsidies, incorporation of the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement, the E-commerce Work Programme and moratorium, agriculture and development, and a close on 30 March. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership and for which the 2018 paper is not among the locally held official papers; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question and which is expressly cross-cutting, with this owner holding the trade, negotiating and external-policy half while topic 12 holds the institutional half; no objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word-limit provenance exactly as observed: 2025 question 10 asking the answer to elucidate the statement that with the waning of globalization the post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question itself and which the Basic owner names as the anchor demand for this topic; 2018 question 19 on the key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, a 15-mark demand of 250 words recorded on a Core route that supersedes the older Advanced ownership; and 2022 question 20 asking the answer to describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question. Two provenance facts are reported rather than repaired. First, the 2018 General Studies Paper II is not among the locally held official papers, so only the audited ledger's own neutral rendering of that demand is carried and its printed stem is deliberately not reconstructed, quoted or paraphrased, while the 2022 and 2025 stems were confirmed word for word against the locally held official papers for those years. Second, the 2022 demand is expressly cross-cutting: the audited ledger records that both the climate regime and multilateral fora are named in the stem, this owner holds the trade, negotiating and external-policy half, and topic 12 holds the institutional half, so the shared ownership is declared rather than silently duplicated or silently dropped. No objective demand from any audited Prelims routing ledger is routed to this owner, so none is listed, invented or answered. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording and word-limit provenance of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or official answer key was imported.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- **FACT: 2025 Q10 (direct):** *""With the waning of globalization, post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism." Elucidate.* **Structure:** (1) define globalisation and sovereign nationalism as co-present forces; (2) cite protectionism, sanctions/export controls and the FTA-over-WTO shift as evidence - the 2025-26 US tariff cycle, the EU CBAM definitive regime and the MC14 failure of the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement despite 165 of 166 members' support; (3) connect to India's own dual navigation (seeking market access via TEPA/CETA while protecting strategic sectors and staying out of RCEP); (4) avoid fabricated statistics - cite only date-stamped, verifiable measures if specifics are required.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	GS-II	10	Waning globalization and post-Cold War sovereign nationalism	Elucidate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Waning globalization and post-Cold War sovereign nationalism

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	19	Key areas of WTO reform in the context of trade war	What are the key areas · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	20	Clean energy and India's climate policy in international fora	Describe briefly · 15 marks · 250 words	IR Core owns diplomatic/institutional dimension	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Key areas of WTO reform in the context of trade war
- Clean energy and India's climate policy in international fora

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2025 Q10 (direct):** "With the waning of globalization, post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism." Elucidate.* An advanced answer should:
 1. Frame globalisation and sovereign nationalism as co-present, relatively shifting forces, not a completed transition.
 2. Trace the three transmission channels (trade, technology, climate) through which sovereign nationalism manifests.
 3. Position India as simultaneously a beneficiary (diversification interest)

and a target (protectionist/climate-measure exposure) of the trend.

4. Cite the FTA-over-WTO shift as continuity of liberalisation through a different institutional form, not simple nationalist retreat.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	19	Key areas of WTO reform in the context of trade war	What are the key areas · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Key areas of WTO reform in the context of trade war

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 10

Demand: "With the waning of globalization, post-Cold War world is becoming a site of sovereign nationalism." Elucidate. (Answer in 150 words). A 10-mark demand whose word limit is printed in the question itself, confirmed word for word against the locally held official General Studies Paper II of 2025.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and named by the Basic owner as the anchor demand for this topic. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the statement is defensible only in its own qualified terms, because the word waning describes a relative shift rather than a completed transition, so the world is becoming a site where sovereign nationalism operates alongside a continuing but institutionally redistributed globalisation. Named evidence and example: the trade channel is evidenced by the migration of liberalisation from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments, with the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025 and the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026, against India-European Union negotiations merely concluded on 27 January 2026; the decision-rule evidence is the fourteenth Ministerial Conference at Yaounde from 26 to 30 March 2026, where the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had 165 of 166 members' support for incorporation yet failed for want of consensus, and the World Trade Organization's own structure page confirming a member-driven, normally consensus-based body whose Ministerial Conference meets at least once every two years; the dispute evidence is the loss of the Appellate Body's quorum on 10 December 2019 and its zero membership since 30 November 2020, with India outside the interim appeal arrangement and its own appeals of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581, of 17 May 2023 in DS584 and of 8 December 2023 in DS582 still listed among current notified appeals; the technology and climate channels are evidenced by the European Commission's record that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026 with authorisation, reporting and certificate-surrender obligations across cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, and by the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India, in which a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty took effect on 7 August 2025, an additional Russian-oil-linked duty of twenty-five per cent took effect on 27 August 2025 and was removed from 7 February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty began on 24 July 2026. Analysis: what has actually waned is the multilateral negotiating function, not

exchange itself, because states continue to liberalise through instruments they can control while simultaneously reasserting control over strategic sectors, technology flows and carbon-intensive imports; India illustrates the co-presence exactly, since it announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership while concluding and bringing into force several other agreements, which is the behaviour of a state managing both faces of the shift rather than choosing between them. Qualification: the elucidation must not upgrade waning into ended, must not treat protectionism and export controls as one instrument, must not read another state's domestic tariff measures as obligations binding on India, must record that a duty lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle so that volatility rather than level is the mechanism, and must not present India as purely a beneficiary or purely a victim of the trend. Why this earns marks: it engages the exact word the examiner chose, evidences each channel with a dated instrument at its correct legal stage, and closes on the dual positioning that the stem's own phrasing invites.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 10", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the statement is defensible only in its own qualified terms, because the word waning describes a relative shift rather than a completed transition, so the world is becoming a site where sovereign nationalism operates alongside a continuing but institutionally redistributed globalisation. Named evidence and example: the trade channel is evidenced by the migration of liberalisation from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments, with the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025 and the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026, against India-European Union negotiations merely concluded on 27 January 2026; the decision-rule evidence is the fourteenth Ministerial Conference at Yaounde from 26 to 30 March 2026, where the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had 165 of 166 members' support for incorporation yet failed for want of consensus, and the World Trade Organization's own structure page confirming a member-driven, normally consensus-based body whose Ministerial Conference meets at least once every two years; the dispute evidence is the loss of the Appellate Body's quorum on 10 December 2019 and its zero membership since 30 November 2020, with India outside the interim appeal arrangement and its own appeals of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581, of 17 May 2023 in DS584 and of 8 December 2023 in DS582 still listed among current notified appeals; the technology and climate channels are evidenced by the European Commission's record that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026 with authorisation, reporting and certificate-surrender obligations across cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, and by the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India, in which a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty took effect on 7 August 2025, an additional Russian-oil-linked duty of twenty-five per cent took effect on 27 August 2025 and was removed from 7 February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty began on 24 July 2026. Analysis: what has actually waned is the multilateral negotiating function, not exchange itself, because states continue to liberalise through instruments they can control while simultaneously reasserting control over strategic sectors, technology flows and carbon-intensive imports; India illustrates the co-presence exactly, since it announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership while concluding and bringing into force several other agreements, which is the behaviour of a state managing both faces of the shift rather than choosing between them. Qualification: the elucidation must not upgrade waning into ended, must not treat protectionism and export controls as one instrument, must not read another state's domestic tariff measures as obligations binding on India, must record that a duty lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle so that volatility rather than level is the mechanism, and must not present India as purely a beneficiary or purely a victim of the trend. Why this earns marks: it engages the exact word the examiner chose, evidences each channel with a dated instrument at its correct legal stage, and closes on the dual positioning that the stem's own phrasing invites.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 10 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership

and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and named by the Basic owner as the anchor demand for this topic. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence.

Qualification: State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the statement is defensible only in its own qualified terms, because the word waning describes a relative shift rather than a completed transition, so the world is becoming a site where sovereign nationalism operates alongside a continuing but institutionally redistributed globalisation. Named evidence and example: the trade channel is evidenced by the migration of liberalisation from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments, with the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025 and the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026, against India-European Union negotiations merely concluded on 27 January 2026; the decision-rule evidence is the fourteenth Ministerial Conference at Yaounde from 26 to 30 March 2026, where the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had 165 of 166 members' support for incorporation yet failed for want of consensus, and the World Trade Organization's own structure page confirming a member-driven, normally consensus-based body whose Ministerial Conference meets at least once every two years; the dispute evidence is the loss of the Appellate Body's quorum on 10 December 2019 and its zero membership since 30 November 2020, with India outside the interim appeal arrangement and its own appeals of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581, of 17 May 2023 in DS584 and of 8 December 2023 in DS582 still listed among current notified appeals; the technology and climate channels are evidenced by the European Commission's record that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026 with authorisation, reporting and certificate-surrender obligations across cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, and by the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India, in which a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty took effect on 7 August 2025, an additional Russian-oil-linked duty of twenty-five per cent took effect on 27 August 2025 and was removed from 7 February 2026, and a separate ten per cent Section 301 duty began on 24 July 2026. Analysis: what has actually waned is the multilateral negotiating function, not exchange itself, because states continue to liberalise through instruments they can control while simultaneously reasserting control over strategic sectors, technology flows and carbon-intensive imports; India illustrates the co-presence exactly, since it announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership while concluding and bringing into force several other agreements, which is the behaviour of a state managing both faces of the shift rather than choosing between them. Qualification: the elucidation must not upgrade waning into ended, must not treat protectionism and export controls as one instrument, must not read another state's domestic tariff measures as obligations binding on India, must record that a duty lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle so that volatility rather than level is the mechanism, and must not present India as purely a beneficiary or purely a victim of the trend. Why this earns marks: it engages the exact word the examiner chose, evidences each channel with a dated instrument at its correct legal stage, and closes on the dual positioning that the stem's own phrasing invites.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 10", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 19

Demand: Key areas of World Trade Organization reform in the context of a trade war, especially keeping in mind India's interest. A What are the key areas demand of 15 marks and 250 words. This is the neutral rendering recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger; the 2018 General Studies Paper II is not among the locally held official papers, so the printed stem is deliberately not reconstructed, quoted or paraphrased into an apparent verbatim wording, and only the ledger's own rendering, directive, marks and word limit are carried here.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed, and the absence of a locally held 2018 paper is reported rather than repaired by an invented or reconstructed stem.

Model solution: Claim: reform must address four areas that map onto the organisation's own architecture, namely dispute settlement, the decision rule, agriculture and development, and the new trade-climate-technology frontier, and India's interest is served by restoration and rebalancing rather than by replacement. Named evidence and example: on dispute settlement, the Appellate Body lost its quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, some thirty members participate in the interim appeal-arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding while India does not, and the organisation's own list of current notified appeals still carries India's notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581, of 17 May 2023 in DS584 and of 8 December 2023 in DS582; on the decision rule, the organisation's structure page records a member-driven body deciding normally by consensus with no power delegated to a board or to its head, and the fourteenth Ministerial Conference at Yaounde from 26 to 30 March 2026 showed the consequence when the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement failed for want of consensus despite 165 of 166 members' support; on agriculture, the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition while the 2013 Bali peace clause gives only interim, conditional protection to eligible public-stockholding programmes; and on the frontier, the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies, adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference on 17 June 2022, reaching its two-thirds threshold at a ceremony on 15 September 2025 and accepted by India on 20 July 2026, shows that a binding multilateral outcome remains achievable, while the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, shows unilateral climate-linked measures filling the space the organisation has not occupied. Analysis: the four areas are interdependent, because a paralysed appellate stage removes the enforcement credibility that makes concessions worth granting, an unreformed consensus convention converts every reform into a hostage of one objection, an unresolved agriculture settlement keeps the largest developing members permanently defensive, and an absent multilateral climate-trade discipline pushes members toward unilateral instruments that then require defensive litigation; India's specific interest is therefore restoration of binding appellate review, a permanent solution on public stockholding with preserved special and differential treatment, realistic decision-rule practice, and multilateral rather than unilateral treatment of climate-linked trade measures. Qualification: the answer must record that the organisation is weakened rather than irrelevant, that the paralysis is two-sided because India can neither be appealed against effectively nor obtain binding review, that the peace clause carries notification and programme conditions, that the carbon mechanism binds importers under another jurisdiction's internal law rather than binding India, that no negotiating outcome is predicted, and that this stem is not confirmable from a locally held paper. Why this earns marks: it converts the vague word reform into four named institutional areas, evidences each with a dated fact from a first-party source, and ties every recommendation to a specific Indian stake.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 19", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: reform must address four areas that map onto the organisation's own architecture, namely dispute settlement, the decision rule, agriculture and development, and the new trade-climate-technology frontier, and India's interest is served by restoration and rebalancing rather than by replacement. Named evidence and example: on dispute settlement, the Appellate Body lost its quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, some thirty members participate in the interim appeal-arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding while India does not, and the organisation's

own list of current notified appeals still carries India's notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581, of 17 May 2023 in DS584 and of 8 December 2023 in DS582; on the decision rule, the organisation's structure page records a member-driven body deciding normally by consensus with no power delegated to a board or to its head, and the fourteenth Ministerial Conference at Yaounde from 26 to 30 March 2026 showed the consequence when the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement failed for want of consensus despite 165 of 166 members' support; on agriculture, the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition while the 2013 Bali peace clause gives only interim, conditional protection to eligible public-stockholding programmes; and on the frontier, the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies, adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference on 17 June 2022, reaching its two-thirds threshold at a ceremony on 15 September 2025 and accepted by India on 20 July 2026, shows that a binding multilateral outcome remains achievable, while the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, shows unilateral climate-linked measures filling the space the organisation has not occupied. Analysis: the four areas are interdependent, because a paralysed appellate stage removes the enforcement credibility that makes concessions worth granting, an unreformed consensus convention converts every reform into a hostage of one objection, an unresolved agriculture settlement keeps the largest developing members permanently defensive, and an absent multilateral climate-trade discipline pushes members toward unilateral instruments that then require defensive litigation; India's specific interest is therefore restoration of binding appellate review, a permanent solution on public stockholding with preserved special and differential treatment, realistic decision-rule practice, and multilateral rather than unilateral treatment of climate-linked trade measures. Qualification: the answer must record that the organisation is weakened rather than irrelevant, that the paralysis is two-sided because India can neither be appealed against effectively nor obtain binding review, that the peace clause carries notification and programme conditions, that the carbon mechanism binds importers under another jurisdiction's internal law rather than binding India, that no negotiating outcome is predicted, and that this stem is not confirmable from a locally held paper. Why this earns marks: it converts the vague word reform into four named institutional areas, evidences each with a dated fact from a first-party source, and ties every recommendation to a specific Indian stake.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 19 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: reform must address four areas that map onto the organisation's own architecture, namely dispute settlement, the decision rule, agriculture and development, and the new trade-climate-technology frontier, and India's interest is served by restoration and rebalancing rather than by replacement. Named evidence and example: on dispute settlement, the Appellate Body lost its quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, some thirty members participate in the interim appeal-arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding while India does not, and the organisation's own list of current notified appeals still carries India's notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581, of 17 May 2023 in DS584 and of 8 December 2023 in DS582; on the decision rule, the organisation's structure page records a member-driven body deciding normally by consensus with no power delegated to a board or to its head, and the fourteenth Ministerial Conference at Yaounde from 26 to 30 March 2026 showed the consequence when the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement failed for want of consensus despite 165 of 166 members' support; on agriculture, the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition while the 2013 Bali peace clause gives only interim, conditional protection to eligible public-stockholding programmes; and on the frontier, the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies, adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference on 17 June 2022, reaching its two-thirds threshold at a ceremony on 15 September 2025 and accepted by India on 20 July 2026, shows that a binding multilateral outcome remains achievable, while the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, shows unilateral climate-linked measures filling the space the organisation has not occupied. Analysis: the four areas are interdependent, because a paralysed

appellate stage removes the enforcement credibility that makes concessions worth granting, an unreformed consensus convention converts every reform into a hostage of one objection, an unresolved agriculture settlement keeps the largest developing members permanently defensive, and an absent multilateral climate-trade discipline pushes members toward unilateral instruments that then require defensive litigation; India's specific interest is therefore restoration of binding appellate review, a permanent solution on public stockholding with preserved special and differential treatment, realistic decision-rule practice, and multilateral rather than unilateral treatment of climate-linked trade measures. Qualification: the answer must record that the organisation is weakened rather than irrelevant, that the paralysis is two-sided because India can neither be appealed against effectively nor obtain binding review, that the peace clause carries notification and programme conditions, that the carbon mechanism binds importers under another jurisdiction's internal law rather than binding India, that no negotiating outcome is predicted, and that this stem is not confirmable from a locally held paper. Why this earns marks: it converts the vague word reform into four named institutional areas, evidences each with a dated fact from a first-party source, and ties every recommendation to a specific Indian stake.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 19", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 20

Demand: 'Clean energy is the order of the day.' Describe briefly India's changing policy towards climate change in various international fora in the context of geopolitics. (Answer in 250 words). A 15-mark demand whose word limit is printed in the question itself, confirmed word for word against the locally held official General Studies Paper II of 2022. The audited ledger records this demand as cross-cutting: this owner holds the trade, negotiating and external-policy half and topic 12 holds the institutional half.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger for its diplomatic and external-policy dimension, with the institutional dimension recorded against topic 12. The shared ownership is declared here rather than silently duplicated. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: India's climate policy in international fora has moved from a primarily defensive equity position to a dual position that combines equity claims with dated domestic commitments and active management of climate-linked trade measures, and geopolitics enters mainly through the last of these. Named evidence and example: under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to reach about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target; its negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access; the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; and the geopolitical edge is supplied by the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, whose definitive regime applies from 1 January 2026 with authorisation, reporting and certificate-surrender obligations covering cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, priced from Emissions Trading System allowance auctions. Analysis: the change is best described as a widening of the arena rather than an abandonment of the equity claim, because a domestic mitigation commitment gives India standing to press for finance and technology while the appearance of climate-linked trade instruments turns climate diplomacy into trade diplomacy, so India now argues simultaneously in the climate regime for differentiated responsibility and in the trade domain against measures that transmit another jurisdiction's climate policy into Indian market access, standards and compliance costs. Qualification: the description must record that targets are commitments rather than realised outcomes, that operationalisation of a funding arrangement is not adequacy of finance, that a carbon-border measure has a genuine climate rationale and its proportionality is contested rather than settled, that India is affected without being a party to the European Union's internal law, and that the institutional structure of the climate and multilateral fora is owned by topic 12 and cited rather than re-argued here. Why this earns

marks: it describes a policy trajectory rather than listing conferences, evidences each stage with dated commitments and one operating instrument, and closes on the geopolitical mechanism the stem explicitly asks for.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 20", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: India's climate policy in international fora has moved from a primarily defensive equity position to a dual position that combines equity claims with dated domestic commitments and active management of climate-linked trade measures, and geopolitics enters mainly through the last of these. Named evidence and example: under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to reach about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target; its negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access; the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; and the geopolitical edge is supplied by the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, whose definitive regime applies from 1 January 2026 with authorisation, reporting and certificate-surrender obligations covering cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, priced from Emissions Trading System allowance auctions. Analysis: the change is best described as a widening of the arena rather than an abandonment of the equity claim, because a domestic mitigation commitment gives India standing to press for finance and technology while the appearance of climate-linked trade instruments turns climate diplomacy into trade diplomacy, so India now argues simultaneously in the climate regime for differentiated responsibility and in the trade domain against measures that transmit another jurisdiction's climate policy into Indian market access, standards and compliance costs. Qualification: the description must record that targets are commitments rather than realised outcomes, that operationalisation of a funding arrangement is not adequacy of finance, that a carbon-border measure has a genuine climate rationale and its proportionality is contested rather than settled, that India is affected without being a party to the European Union's internal law, and that the institutional structure of the climate and multilateral fora is owned by topic 12 and cited rather than re-argued here. Why this earns marks: it describes a policy trajectory rather than listing conferences, evidences each stage with dated commitments and one operating instrument, and closes on the geopolitical mechanism the stem explicitly asks for.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 20 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: India's climate policy in international fora has moved from a primarily defensive equity position to a dual position that combines equity claims with dated domestic commitments and active management of climate-linked trade measures, and geopolitics enters mainly through the last of these. Named evidence and example: under its updated 2022 Nationally Determined Contribution India committed by 2030 to reduce the emissions intensity of gross domestic product by forty-five per cent from 2005 levels and to reach about fifty per cent cumulative installed electric-power capacity from non-fossil sources, with net zero by 2070 as the long-term target; its negotiating position combines equity and common but differentiated responsibilities and respective capabilities with climate finance and technology access; the Loss and Damage funding arrangements were operationalised at the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties, recognising vulnerable-country loss beyond mitigation and adaptation while adequacy, access and contributor scale remain contested; and the geopolitical edge is supplied by the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism, whose definitive regime applies from 1 January 2026 with authorisation, reporting and

certificate-surrender obligations covering cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, priced from Emissions Trading System allowance auctions. Analysis: the change is best described as a widening of the arena rather than an abandonment of the equity claim, because a domestic mitigation commitment gives India standing to press for finance and technology while the appearance of climate-linked trade instruments turns climate diplomacy into trade diplomacy, so India now argues simultaneously in the climate regime for differentiated responsibility and in the trade domain against measures that transmit another jurisdiction's climate policy into Indian market access, standards and compliance costs. Qualification: the description must record that targets are commitments rather than realised outcomes, that operationalisation of a funding arrangement is not adequacy of finance, that a carbon-border measure has a genuine climate rationale and its proportionality is contested rather than settled, that India is affected without being a party to the European Union's internal law, and that the institutional structure of the climate and multilateral fora is owned by topic 12 and cited rather than re-argued here. Why this earns marks: it describes a policy trajectory rather than listing conferences, evidences each stage with dated commitments and one operating instrument, and closes on the geopolitical mechanism the stem explicitly asks for.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 20", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment on the proposition that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral trade agreements reflects continuity of, rather than retreat from, globalisation. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The proposition is largely correct but must be evidenced through legal stages rather than asserted, so the comment must show liberalisation migrating from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments and then concede the fragmentation cost.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners.
- The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means.
- The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power

is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.

- The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition is largely correct but must be evidenced through legal stages rather than asserted, so the comment must show liberalisation migrating from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments and then concede the fragmentation cost.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on "Comment on the proposition that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral trade agreements...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The proposition is largely correct but must be evidenced through legal stages rather than asserted, so the comment must show liberalisation migrating from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments and then concede the fragmentation cost.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners argue that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral agreements is a continuation of trade liberalisation through a different institutional form rather than a nationalist retreat from trade, since such agreements are pursued precisely because multilateral liberalisation has stalled, and they attach the genuine costs in the same place: a growing patchwork of agreements each with different rules of origin and standards raises compliance complexity relative to a single multilateral rulebook, de-risking requires investment in alternative capacity that is neither instantaneous nor costless, climate-linked measures risk being perceived as disguised protectionism, the paralysed appellate stage cuts both ways, and domestic strategic-sector support schemes can themselves invite reciprocal trade friction from partners. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership

and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition is largely correct but must be evidenced through legal stages rather than asserted, so the comment must show liberalisation migrating from a stalled multilateral forum into dated bilateral instruments and then concede the fragmentation cost.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment on the proposition that the spread of bilateral and plurilateral trade agreements...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment on the claim that the World Trade Organization has become irrelevant to India's trade policy.
Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The claim is wrong as stated but points at a real weakness, so the comment must separate the negotiating function from the dispute and rule-baseline functions and date the paralysis precisely.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one.
- The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.
- The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance.
- The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.

Qualified conclusion: The claim is wrong as stated but points at a real weakness, so the comment must separate the negotiating function from the dispute and rule-baseline functions and date the paralysis precisely.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on "Comment on the claim that the World Trade Organization has become irrelevant to India's trade...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The claim is wrong as stated but points at a real weakness, so the comment must separate the negotiating function from the dispute and rule-baseline functions and date the paralysis precisely.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the organisation is run by its member governments, that all major decisions are made by the membership as a whole either by ministers meeting at least once every two years or by their delegates in Geneva, that decisions are normally taken by consensus, that power is not delegated to a board of directors or to the organisation's head, that rules are enforced by the members themselves with sanctions imposed by member countries and authorised by the membership as a whole, and that the Ministerial Conference is the topmost body while the General Council, the Dispute Settlement Body and the Trade Policy Review Body are the same body meeting under different terms of reference; the owners add that the organisation was established in 1995 with India a founding member and that it remains the reference framework for baseline rules even as its negotiating function has weakened, so it is a weakened institution and expressly not an irrelevant one. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The World Trade Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies prohibits harmful fisheries subsidies, that it is the first agreement of the organisation to focus on the environment, the first broad binding multilateral agreement on ocean sustainability and only the second multilateral agreement reached at the organisation since its inception, that it was adopted at the twelfth Ministerial Conference in June 2022, that it entered into force once two-thirds of members deposited instruments of acceptance and that this threshold was reached at a ceremony on 15 September 2025, that it delivers the eleventh Ministerial Conference mandate in the Buenos Aires Ministerial Decision and Sustainable Development Goal 14.6, and that negotiations on additional provisions continue under the Negotiating Group on Rules; the owners add the Indian step that completes the sequence, recording adoption on 17 June 2022, entry into force on 15 September 2025 and India's deposit of its instrument of acceptance on 20 July 2026, which together give a single worked chain from adoption through entry into force to individual acceptance. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why

the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.

Analysis: Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The claim is wrong as stated but points at a real weakness, so the comment must separate the negotiating function from the dispute and rule-baseline functions and date the paralysis precisely.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment on the claim that the World Trade Organization has become irrelevant to India's trade...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the channels through which another state's or bloc's economic policy choice transmits into India's external interests. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Transmission is channel-specific rather than general, so the examination must name the trade, technology and climate channels, evidence each with a dated instrument and show why a single contemporary measure can occupy all three.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect.
- The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law.
- The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating

exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.

- This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12.

Qualified conclusion: Transmission is channel-specific rather than general, so the examination must name the trade, technology and climate channels, evidence each with a dated instrument and show why a single contemporary measure can occupy all three.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the channels through which another state's or bloc's economic policy choice transmits...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Transmission is channel-specific rather than general, so the examination must name the trade, technology and climate channels, evidence each with a dated instrument and show why a single contemporary measure can occupy all three.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners identify three channels through which sovereign-nationalist policy reaches Indian interests: a trade channel running through protectionism, the shift from multilateral liberalisation toward bilateral and plurilateral agreements and the stagnation of the multilateral negotiating function; a technology channel running through export controls, investment screening and de-risking; and a climate channel running through carbon-border measures and green-subsidy competition; they add that a contemporary instrument frequently combines all three objectives at once, which makes classical tariff-only analysis inadequate, and they require an answer to name the channel before describing the effect. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the

International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** This topic owns the diplomatic and strategic meaning of the international economic order for India: how globalisation and sovereign nationalism operate together, how another state's or bloc's economic and regulatory choices transmit into Indian market access, technology access and climate-compliance costs, what exact legal stage each trade instrument has reached, and how India answers through negotiation, dispute mechanisms and rule-shaping; its distinctive feature is that the same structural shift makes India simultaneously a beneficiary of diversification interest and a target of others' measures, and three General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018, 2022 and 2025 are routed here, while tariff schedules, balance-of-payments and trade-modelling mechanics belong to the Economy owner, de-risking and friend-shoring detail to topic 03, and the institutional mandate and structure of the World Trade Organization in full to topic 12. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Transmission is channel-specific rather than general, so the examination must name the trade, technology and climate channels, evidence each with a dated instrument and show why a single contemporary measure can occupy all three.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the channels through which another state's or bloc's economic policy choice transmits...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why precision about legal stage is decisive in any answer about India's trade agreements. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Legal stage decides what a state is actually obliged to do, so the examination must run the concluded, signed and in-force ladder with named agreements and then show what an imprecise claim would falsely assert.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive

Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means.

- The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access.
- The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used.
- The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer.

Qualified conclusion: Legal stage decides what a state is actually obliged to do, so the examination must run the concluded, signed and in-force ladder with named agreements and then show what an imprecise claim would falsely assert.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why precision about legal stage is decisive in any answer about India's trade...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Legal stage decides what a state is actually obliged to do, so the examination must run the concluded, signed and in-force ladder with named agreements and then show what an imprecise claim would falsely assert.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners require every trade instrument to be described at its exact legal stage, and they supply a dated ladder for India: the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force from 1 May 2022 and the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement in force from 29 December 2022 at the top; the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 10 March 2024 and in force from 1 October 2025; the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement signed at London on 24 July 2025 and in force from 15 July 2026; the India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the India-New Zealand agreement signed on 27 April 2026; the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with negotiations concluded on 5 December 2025; the India-European Union agreement with negotiations concluded on 27 January 2026 but neither signed nor in force; and the India-United States relationship carrying an interim framework and continuing negotiation with no comprehensive agreement in force; the discipline is that concluded, signed, ratified and in force are four different claims and that an answer must name the one it means.

Analysis: Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument

-> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the India-United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement as signed at London on 24 July 2025 and entered into force on 15 July 2026, with the Double Contributions Convention entering into force on the same day and providing up to sixty months of home-country social-security coverage for detached workers; the owners treat the paired instrument as analytically significant rather than incidental, because it shows that a contemporary trade agreement carries mobility and social-security machinery alongside tariff concessions, which is exactly the kind of provision an answer on services-led trade interests should cite instead of a general claim about market access. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that India-European Union free trade agreement negotiations were concluded on 27 January 2026 at the sixteenth India-European Union Summit and that the agreement was neither signed nor ratified nor in force, and they record that the same summit signed a Security and Defence Partnership, launched negotiations on a Security of Information Agreement and adopted the document Towards 2030: India-European Union Joint Comprehensive Strategic Agenda; the owners use the summit as the cleanest available demonstration that concluded, signed, launched and adopted are four different verbs carrying four different obligations inside one communique, so an answer must reproduce the verb the source actually used. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the India-European Free Trade Association Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement as signed on 10 March 2024 and entered into force on 1 October 2025, and they record in the same place that the figure of one hundred billion United States dollars over fifteen years and one million direct jobs is a shared objective stated in the agreement's framework rather than realised investment or realised employment; the examinable consequence is that a negotiated aspiration must never be cited as delivered outcome, because doing so converts a bargaining target into a fact and destroys the credibility of every other figure in the same answer. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Legal stage decides what a state is actually obliged to do, so the examination must run the concluded, signed and in-force ladder with named agreements and then show what an imprecise claim would falsely assert.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine why precision about legal stage is decisive in any answer about India's trade...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the proposition that India is simultaneously a beneficiary and a target of the shift towards sovereign nationalism. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Both positions are true at once and the assessment must hold them together, evidencing the beneficiary side through India's own agreement cycle and the target side through unilateral tariffs and carbon-border measures before delivering a graded verdict.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic.
- The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate.
- The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name.
- The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law.

Qualified conclusion: Both positions are true at once and the assessment must hold them together, evidencing the beneficiary side through India's own agreement cycle and the target side through unilateral tariffs and carbon-border measures before delivering a graded verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the proposition that India is simultaneously a beneficiary and a target of the shift...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Both positions are true at once and the assessment must hold them together, evidencing the beneficiary side through India's own agreement cycle and the target side through unilateral tariffs and carbon-border measures before delivering a graded verdict.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners insist that globalisation, understood as the intensifying cross-border integration of trade, capital, technology and information flows that characterised the post-Cold-War decades, and sovereign nationalism, understood as a resurgent emphasis on national control over trade, technology, borders and strategic industries expressed through protectionism, export controls and buy-national industrial policy, are simultaneously operating forces of differing relative strength across sectors and states rather than sequential eras; they anchor the point in the wording of the routed 2025 demand itself, which says waning rather than ended, and they treat the correction of a binary globalisation-is-over narrative as the single highest-value framing move available in this topic. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that India announced on 4 November 2019 that it would not join the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, and they treat the decision as the boundary marker of India's trade strategy rather than as a retreat from trade, because the same period saw India conclude and bring into force several bilateral and plurilateral agreements; the analytical use is that a state seeking market access abroad while protecting selected domestic sectors is navigating both faces of the structural shift at once, which is precisely the dual positioning the routed 2025 demand asks an answer to elucidate. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the 2025-26 United States tariff cycle on India in dated sequence: a twenty-five per cent reciprocal duty effective 7 August 2025, an additional twenty-five per cent duty linked to Russian oil effective 27 August 2025 and removed from 7 February 2026, additional duties under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act ending in February 2026, and a separate ten per cent duty under Section 301 from 24 July 2026; they attach two analytical points in the same place, namely that these are another state's domestic measures creating exposure rather than obligations binding on India, and that a measure lasting under six months still shaped a full negotiating cycle, so volatility rather than tariff level is the transmission mechanism an answer should name. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The European Commission page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism applies in its definitive regime from 1 January 2026, that the regime introduces authorisation requirements, reporting obligations and the purchase and surrender of certificates corresponding to the embedded carbon emissions of imported goods, that it applies to imports of selected goods in cement, iron and steel, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, that certificate prices are calculated from European Union Emissions Trading System allowance auction prices and that a transitional phase ran from 2023 to 2025; the owners add the classification point that such a measure functions simultaneously as a trade instrument, an industrial-policy tool and a climate instrument, that affected exporters including India may contest its proportionality or fairness, and that India is affected through market access, standards and negotiating strategy without being bound as a party to the European Union's internal law. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Both positions are true at once and the assessment must hold them together, evidencing the beneficiary side through India's own agreement cycle and the target side through unilateral tariffs and carbon-border measures before delivering a graded verdict.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the proposition that India is simultaneously a beneficiary and a target of the shift...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess what a credible Indian reform agenda for the multilateral trading system should contain. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Reform is distributive as well as procedural, so the assessment must combine dispute-settlement restoration, agriculture and public stockholding, decision-rule realism and climate-trade linkage, and must refuse to predict any negotiating outcome.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural.
- The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12.
- The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others.
- The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power.

Qualified conclusion: Reform is distributive as well as procedural, so the assessment must combine dispute-settlement restoration, agriculture and public stockholding, decision-rule realism and climate-trade linkage, and must refuse to predict any negotiating outcome.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess what a credible Indian reform agenda for the multilateral trading system should...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Reform is distributive as well as procedural, so the assessment must combine dispute-settlement restoration, agriculture and public stockholding, decision-rule realism and climate-trade linkage, and must refuse to predict any negotiating outcome.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the Agreement on Agriculture disciplines market access, domestic support and export competition, that the 2013 Bali peace clause protects eligible developing-country public-stockholding programmes from specified legal challenge while members negotiate a permanent solution, and that India's reform demand is to preserve public stockholding and special and differential treatment while improving subsidy and market-access rules; they attach two limits in the same place, namely that the interim protection carries notification and programme conditions and is not the permanent settlement India seeks, and that producer support, consumer food security and export effects must all be balanced, which is why reform in this organisation is distributive rather than merely procedural. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that at the fourteenth Ministerial Conference the Investment Facilitation for Development agreement had the support of 165 of 166 members for incorporation into the rulebook and 129 parties supporting implementation, yet consensus was absent and incorporation failed, and they draw the precise lesson that in this organisation the veto point is procedural rather than majoritarian; the analytical payoff they attach is structural, because the same consensus convention that protects every member from being outvoted also converts a single objection into a blockage, which is why near-unanimity is never a decision and why the blockage is comparable in form, though not in law, to the permanent-member veto problem owned by topic 12. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the Appellate Body lost its three-member quorum for new appeals on 10 December 2019 and has had zero members since 30 November 2020, that some thirty members participate in the interim multi-party interim appeal arbitration arrangement under Article 25 of the Dispute Settlement Understanding but India is not among them, and that an adverse panel report can therefore be appealed into the void; the organisation's own list of current notified appeals checked live on 2026-09-03 shows this operating in India's own docket, recording India's notification of appeal of 8 December 2023 in DS582 on tariff treatment of certain information and communications technology goods, its notification of 17 May 2023 in DS584 on tariff treatment of certain goods in the dispute brought by Japan and its three notifications of 24 December 2021 in DS579, DS580 and DS581 on measures concerning sugar and sugarcane; the owners insist the cost is two-sided, because India equally cannot obtain binding appellate review against others. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record from the Economic Survey 2025-26 that India ranked forty-fourth of one hundred and forty-five countries on the Harvard Economic Complexity Index in 2023, up from

fifty-seventh in 2013 but unchanged since 2019, and they treat this as a structural indicator of the composition of India's export basket rather than as a measure of trade volume or of policy success; the examinable use is that an answer recommending diversification can ground the recommendation in a dated composition indicator instead of asserting a general need to diversify, while conceding that the index measures capability composition and not market access, tariff exposure or bargaining power. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Reform is distributive as well as procedural, so the assessment must combine dispute-settlement restoration, agriculture and public stockholding, decision-rule realism and climate-trade linkage, and must refuse to predict any negotiating outcome.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess what a credible Indian reform agenda for the multilateral trading system should...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.